

worship their bodies and everything they can do with them: sing, dance, play volleyball, have sex, eat, drink, and jog. A given body may be fat or thin, black or white, or male or female. It may be beautiful or marred. But that body loves to prance around Ipanema, showing itself to others in various degrees of undress.

In Rio de Janeiro, the English-language newspaper tells of furnished apartments or apart-hotels. For shorter stays, I recommend one of the smaller hotels in Ipanema. Stay a block or two from the beach and figure on \$6 a night for a double room. If you want to splurge, the Hotel Praia Ipanema on the beach offers spectacular views and first-class luxury for about \$30 a day. We sometimes stay there if we're only in Rio for a day or two.

Every Saturday afternoon Brazilians eat *feijoada*, a black-bean stew with sausages, pork, beef, preserved salted fish, and mysterious animal parts. When my mother-in-law first hoisted a spoonful of *feijoada*, it had a small tail on it. One accompanies *feijoada* with white rice, stir-fried collard greens, sliced oranges, and root meal.

For the less adventurous, Brazilians put meat on three-foot-long swords and roast it over an open fire. Waiters bring the skewers to your table, put the point on your plate, and slide off a chicken heart, small sausage, or piece of chicken, or slice off a bit of pork, ham, or beef. The meal is called a *churrasco*, and includes french fries, fruit, and all the skewered meat you want for about \$3.

If you know any Romance language you'll be able to get by in Portuguese. But if all you ever learn to say is *tudo bem* you'll do fine. *Tudo bem* means "everything's great." Brazilians say *tudo bem* instead of "good morning," "how are you?" or even "how was your day yesterday?" Since to a Brazilian everything is always great, the presumption is that *tudo bem* covers all possibilities. Even if there's a problem to resolve, both sides start their talk with *tudo bem*.

Rio has a lot of street crime. Leave your gold jewelry and